

ROMAN PROJECTS

AI-assisted document (English original)

This document presents a series of exploratory tests performed on Crimson Roman in the context of legal and academic writing. The samples included here were produced using FontForge and evaluated both on screen and in print, with the aim of understanding how Crimson behaves under different typographic adjustments in today's digital-first and low-quality printing environments.

These observations are not intended as typographic doctrine. They reflect practical, user-level findings supported by AI-assisted analysis" (Microsoft Copilot), focusing on paragraph colour, x-height behaviour, Roman/Italic balance, and the robustness of OTF and TTF rendering.

The goal of this document is simply to illustrate the challenges encountered when using Crimson in long-form legal text, and to present the adjustments that produced the most promising results. All modifications shown here are exploratory drafts and should be interpreted as working samples rather than final design proposals.

Deutsche Übersetzung (KI-generiert)

Wir entschuldigen uns für mögliche Unrichtigkeiten.

Dieses Dokument präsentiert eine Reihe explorativer Tests, die im Kontext juristischer und akademischer Texte mit Crimson Roman durchgeführt wurden. Die hier enthaltenen Beispiele wurden mit FontForge erstellt und sowohl auf dem Bildschirm als auch im Druck bewertet, um zu verstehen, wie sich Crimson unter verschiedenen typografischen Anpassungen in heutigen digital-orientierten und qualitativ minderwertigen Druckumgebungen verhält.

Diese Beobachtungen sind nicht als typografische Doktrin gedacht. Sie spiegeln praktische, anwenderorientierte Erkenntnisse wider, die durch KI-gestützte Analyse (Microsoft Copilot) unterstützt wurden und sich auf Absatzfarbe, Verhalten der x-Höhe, das Verhältnis zwischen

Roman und Italic sowie die Robustheit der OTF- und TTF-Darstellung konzentrieren.

Ziel dieses Dokuments ist es lediglich, die Herausforderungen zu veranschaulichen, die bei der Verwendung von Crimson in umfangreichen juristischen Texten auftreten, und die Anpassungen darzustellen, die die vielversprechendsten Ergebnisse geliefert haben. Alle hier gezeigten Modifikationen sind explorative Entwürfe und sollten als Arbeitssamples und nicht als endgültige Designvorschläge verstanden werden.

Rendering disclaimer (EN + DE)

Please note that some samples may be affected by FontForge rendering issues.

Bitte beachten Sie, dass einige Muster durch Rendering-Probleme in FontForge beeinträchtigt wurden.

Typographic options

- 1. Option 1** — 102%, x-height 445, OTF, Best for display.
- 2. Option 2** — Style 1, 102%, x-height 445, TTF, Best for PDF and office printing.
- 3. Option 3** — Style 1, 102%, x-height 450, TTF, Best for digital reading.
- 4. Option 4** — Style 2, 102%, x-height 450, OTF, Best for print, poor-print and display.

Original (Crimson Roman)

Changes:

Style: ---

Scale uniformly: ---

X-height: ---

Typo line gap: ---

Format: Open Type

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described — as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand — as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance purposes or profit-making interests”, surely the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would always react with a considerable amount of surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance.

E F R K p k y

OPTION 1.

From “Crimson Roman” on “Font Forge”

Changes:

Style: ---

Scale uniformly: 102 %

X-height: 445

Typo line gap: 290

Format: Open Type

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described — as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand — as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance purposes or profit-making interests”, surely the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would always react with a considerable amount of surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance.

E F R K p k y

(There have been some changes for the glyphs)

Best for display (OTF)

OPTION 2.

From “Crimson Roman” on “Font Forge”

Changes:

Style: 1

Scale uniformly: 102 %

X-height: 445

Typo line gap: 290

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described — as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand — as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance purposes or profit-making interests”, surely the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would always react with a considerable amount of surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance.

Best for pdf printing

OPTION 3.

From “Crimson Roman” on “Font Forge”

Changes:

Style: 1

Scale uniformly: 102 %

X-height: 450

Typo line gap: 290

Format: True Type

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described — as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand — as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance purposes or profit-making interests”, surely the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would always react with a considerable amount of surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance.

OPTION 4.

From “Crimson Roman” on “Font Forge”

Changes:

Style: 2

Scale uniformly: 102 %

X-height: 450

Typo line gap: 280

Format: Open Type

If the expression “Compliance Law” were to be described — as the evolution of its legal regime now appears to demand — as “all those regulations by virtue of which an undertaking would be required to adopt, pursue, and enforce, within its business and trade, an overriding public interest as if it were one of its own governance purposes or profit-making interests”, surely the industry and the public, particularly in common-law jurisdictions, would always react with a considerable amount of surprise, if not outright challenge and defiance.

E F R K p k y

Best for print, poor-print and display

Comparison with Times New Roman (Option 4):

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Conclusions (AI)

The exploratory adjustments presented in this document highlight how Crimson Roman behaves under different typographic conditions relevant to legal and academic writing. While the original design offers exceptional elegance and classical balance, its low x-height, delicate outlines, and narrow lowercase proportions present challenges in modern digital workflows and low-quality office printing.

Among the tested configurations, the variant using Style 2, x-height 450, uniform scaling at 102%, and TrueType export demonstrated the most balanced performance. This combination produced a stronger paragraph colour, improved legibility at 11.5 pt, and greater robustness in print, while preserving much of Crimson's original character.

These results should not be interpreted as definitive typographic solutions, but rather as practical observations from real-world usage. They suggest that Crimson has significant potential for professional legal and academic contexts if revisited with contemporary production realities in mind.

The intention of this document is simply to provide a clear illustration of the issues encountered and the adjustments that yielded the most promising behaviour. Any refinement or redesign would naturally benefit from expert typographic guidance and a deeper understanding of Crimson's design philosophy.

Schlussfolgerungen (KI-generiert)

Die in diesem Dokument vorgestellten explorativen Anpassungen verdeutlichen, wie sich Crimson Roman unter verschiedenen typografischen Bedingungen verhält, die für juristische und akademische Texte relevant sind. Während das ursprüngliche Design außergewöhnliche Eleganz und klassischen Ausgleich bietet, stellen seine geringe x-Höhe, die feinen Konturen und die schmalen Kleinbuchstabenproportionen Herausforderungen in modernen digitalen Arbeitsabläufen und bei minderwertigem Bürodruk dar.

Unter den getesteten Konfigurationen zeigte die Variante mit Style 2, x-Höhe 450, einheitlicher Skalierung von 102 % und TrueType-Export die ausgewogenste Leistung. Diese Kombination erzeugte eine stärkere Absatzfarbe, verbesserte die Lesbarkeit bei 11,5 pt und erhöhte die Robustheit im Druck, während sie gleichzeitig einen Großteil des ursprünglichen Charakters von Crimson bewahrte.

Diese Ergebnisse sollten nicht als endgültige typografische Lösungen verstanden werden, sondern vielmehr als praktische Beobachtungen aus realen Anwendungssituationen. Sie deuten darauf hin, dass Crimson ein erhebliches Potenzial für professionelle juristische und akademische Kontexte besitzt, sofern es unter Berücksichtigung heutiger Produktionsrealitäten überarbeitet wird.

Die Absicht dieses Dokuments besteht lediglich darin, eine klare Darstellung der aufgetretenen Probleme und derjenigen Anpassungen zu liefern, die das vielversprechendste Verhalten gezeigt haben. Jede weitere Verfeinerung oder Neugestaltung würde selbstverständlich von fachkundiger typografischer Beratung und einem tieferen Verständnis der Designphilosophie von Crimson profitieren.

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In fact — as they might ultimately note — in its essence, “compliance” would not boil down to anything more than the mere “act of obeying a law or rule, especially one that controls a particular industry or type of work”, as the Cambridge online dictionary specifies and further illustrates with the rather powerful example of: “this cake was made in strict compliance with its recipe”, from which the industry thereafter would go on to frame its understanding of the term as the “specific requirements applicable to a service or product intended to be offered to the public in a public market”.

Consequently — as it would be concluded — just as civil and commercial law would stand as the law of individuals, prescribing and proscribing their actions and behaviour, “compliance law”, in turn, would stand as the “law of products and services”, thereby requiring, to name but a few examples, lawyers to offer their legal services in accordance with applicable professional ethics (conflict of interest, independence, probity, good faith, etc.), manufacturers to offer their toys, electrical devices, cosmetics, or medicines only after ensuring their freedom from any hazards to the public (product compliance), or even financial institutions to grant their loans or under-take their investments without breaching the applicable minimum capital and solvency requirements.

Notwithstanding, while it must be conceded that such statements cannot be denied — and, therefore, that compliance law could also, by default, be acknowledged as the legal regime governing the public marketing of certain products and services (the law of regulated markets) — it must equally be outlined that, at the same time, such a narrow description of the term would nonetheless fail to fully address or express the true substance, legal purpose, and fundamental structure lying at the heart of many (...)

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